

Glossary

Antibiotic

A medical drug that kills or slows down the growth of bacteria and other microorganisms.

Antiseptic

A substance that prevents the growth of organisms that can cause disease.

Apartheid

A policy of racial segregation that was enforced by the South African government from 1948 to 1994.

Archaeology

The study of history through analysis of excavation sites and remains.

Astronomy

The study of science that relates to space, the planets, and the Universe.

Bacteria

Single-celled microorganisms, some of which can cause diseases.

Binary code

A system that uses the digits 1 and 0 to represent a number, letter, or character.

Bolsheviks

A faction within the Russian Social Democratic Party, which later became the Communist party in 1918.

Browser

A computer program that allows people to find, view, and navigate between different websites or web pages.

Chemistry

The study of science that relates to substances, and the way they interact, change, and combine.

Civil rights

The rights of citizens to be socially and politically equal.

Cold War

Period of hostility (1946–1991) between communist nations (led by the Soviet Union) and capitalist nations (led by the US) that stopped short of actual war.

Colony

A territory under political control of another country, usually occupied by settlers from that country.

Communism

A system of government in which the state controls the economy, and goods are equally shared.

Constitution

A set of laws or rules that determine the political principles of a government.

Democracy

A government elected by the people.

Element

A substance in which all the atoms are the same, and cannot be broken down by another substance.

Empire

A group of countries under single political or military rule.

Enlightenment (Buddhism)

The state of spiritual knowledge, which frees a person from the cycle of rebirth.

Entrepreneur

An individual who takes on a financial risk to run a business.

Evolution

The theory of how species adapt to their surroundings over a long time.

Fossil

The remains of past animal or plant life found in rocks.

Genetics

A branch of biology that explores heredity and how traits are passed on through generations.

Heresy

The act of holding opinions that go against the teachings of the church.

Martyr

A person who is killed for refusing to renounce their religious beliefs.

Mecca

This city is in modern-day Saudi Arabia, and is the spiritual center of Islam.

Microchip

A computer component used to carry out a range of electronic functions.

Morality

Beliefs based on the principles of what is right and wrong.

Patent

The exclusive rights held by an inventor or company to make use of a specific process or invention.

Physics

The study of science relating primarily to energy and matter.

Psychology

The scientific study of the mind and how it relates to human behavior.

Renaissance

A period from the 14th to 16th centuries in Europe when there was a surge of interest in the arts and sciences.

Revolution

Overthrowing a government or political system, usually with force.

Saint

A person recognized by the church as being exceptionally virtuous.

Server

A computer, or software on a computer, providing services to other computers that connect to it over a network.

Suffrage

The right to vote in a political election.

Vaccination

Precautionary medical treatment that stops you contracting a disease.

World Wide Web

An interconnected set of hyperlinked documents spread throughout the Internet.